Action – Ready · SRD 5.2.1

The **Ready** action lets you **delay a response**: you pick a **trigger** you can perceive and what you will do when it happens. When it occurs, you use your **Reaction** to act.

It's the tool of the waiting guard, the archer watching the door or the mage holding a spell.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You pick a perceivable **trigger**.
2. Response: an **action** or a **move** (up to your Speed).
3. It costs your **Reaction** (1 per round).
4. Lasts until the **start of your next turn**.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 rephrases the rule: Ready consumes the Reaction, and a readied spell is held with **Concentration**.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say what a "precise enough" trigger is. Fix: it must describe something observable, not an intention ("when the door opens", not "when he's dangerous").

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can ask the player to say the trigger and response aloud so the whole table remembers them.

Step 1 – Announce:

During your turn, say: "I ready. When [trigger], I [response]."

Step 2 – Pick the response:

An action (Attack, Dodge, Help...) or a move of up to your Speed.

Step 3 – Wait:

Your turn ends. The action stays pending until the start of your next turn.

Step 4 – React:

When the trigger occurs, you may act **right after** it, or ignore it. Your Reaction is then spent.

Step 5 – Spells:

A readied spell must have a casting time of **one action**. You cast it now (slot spent), then hold it with **Concentration**.

Example: Tarn, an archer, readies: "When the goblin leaves the corridor, I shoot." The goblin appears, Tarn uses his Reaction and shoots.

⚠ Common questions:

How is it different from waiting?

Ready acts during another's turn, using your Reaction.

Can I ready a move?

Yes, up to your Speed.

And a spell?

Yes, if its casting time is an action; you hold it with Concentration.

What if nothing happens?

The spell dissipates at the start of your turn and the slot is lost.

Can I ignore the trigger?

Yes, you may choose not to react.

Reaction already spent?

Then the readied response can't happen.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Readied bonus action

The SRD lists actions, not bonus actions. **Option**: refuse.

Extra Attack

Readying an Attack gives a single attack. **Option**: all attacks.

Vague trigger

What about a fuzzy trigger? **Option**: the DM refuses and asks to rephrase.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Reaction

Ready uses your Reaction, one per round.

Concentration

A readied spell needs Concentration; if it breaks, the spell dissipates.

Next turn start

The pending action expires then.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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